



St Gerard's Parish Weekly Bulletin

9th August 2026



Welcome to Celebrate Today's Liturgy Mass Times

Saturday Vigil- 18.30

Sunday Mass—10.30

Monday—Liturgy of The Word 9.30

Tuesday Mass -9.30

Wednesday Mass- 9.30

Thursday OMPH Novena Prayer Service- 9.30

Thursday OMPH Novena Mass—19.30

Friday Mass - 9.30

Saturday Silent Meditation—9.30

Holy Days Vigil 7.30pm Morning 9:30

Reconciliation Saturday 17.30—18.15
otherwise by appointment with Priest

Baptisms 2nd and 4th Sundays—Baptism
Preparation course 5pm on 1st Monday of each
month for those wishing to have their child Baptised
in St Gerard's—ring Parish office to arrange both.

Priest Fr Patrick O'Keeffe CSsR ADM

Parish Office 028 90 774833
726 Antrim Road (office hrs M-F 9.30-1.30)

Email stgerards@downandconnor.org

Website stgerardsparish.org

Church Services: Our live streaming web
address has been updated. To access MCN
Media, please go to www.mcn.live on your web
browser. THE CHURCH WEBCAM CAN BE ACCESSED
VIA

mcn.live/Camera/st-gerards-church-newtownabbey

(Playback available on **Recorded** services only -
Recording Requests can be made through Parish
office)

**For Anniversary Mass Intentions on preferred dates—
Please (if possible) make requests 3-4 weeks in advance*

The Apostles' Creed

I believe in God, the Father almighty,
Creator of heaven and earth,
and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord,
who was conceived by the Holy Spirit,
born of the Virgin Mary,
suffered under Pontius Pilate,
was crucified, died and was buried;
he descended into hell;
on the third day
he rose again from the dead;
he ascended into heaven,
and is seated at the right hand of
God the Father almighty;
from there he will come to judge the
living and the dead.
I believe in the Holy Spirit,
the holy catholic Church,
the communion of saints,
the forgiveness of sins,
the resurrection of the body,
and life everlasting. Amen.

Prayer for Vocations

Loving and Generous God,
it is You who call us by name and ask us to follow you.
Help us to grow in the Love and service of our Church
as we experience it today.

Give us the energy and courage of Your Spirit to shape its future.
Grant us faith-filled leaders who will embrace Christ's Mission
of love and justice.

Bless the Church by raising up dedicated and generous leaders
from our families and friends who will serve Your people
as Sisters, Priests, Brothers, Permanent Deacons
and Lay Ministers.

Inspire us to know You better and open our hearts to
hear Your call.

We ask this through Christ our Lord. Amen

**Bishop Alan will be celebrating Mass in Irish as part of the Fleadh on
Sunday August 9th at 11am in St Patrick's Church , Donegal Street .**

22nd/23rd August—Nicola Fitzpatrick will come along to talk to us
about SERVE—2026 Flip Flop Appeal—support enables SERVE to
sustain vital projects that create opportunities for vulnerable
communities in the Global South. This annual initiative raises
awareness and funds to support employment opportunities for
women and young people in communities across Africa and Asia.

24 Hours of Adoration on the Feast of Our Lady's Assumption To
honour the Feast of Our Lady's Assumption the Legion of Mary are
organising 24 hours of Eucharistic Adoration in St Agnes Church.
Adoration will begin after the 7pm Mass on Friday 14th August and
will continue throughout the night and throughout the day, ending
before 6.30 vigil Mass on 15th August. St Theresa of Calcutta
described time spent with Jesus in the Blessed Sacrament as the
"best time you will spend on earth". Please come along and give
thanks to Our Lady and her Son Jesus

**Embrace the Grace' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August
2026 - Legion of Mary**—'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith
and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass,
confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary
headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin
7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults
from across the country. This event takes place on Saturday 29 August
from 9.30am to 6.00pm with a social afterward. Tickets cost €20 and
can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the
Grace'. Any queries can be directed towards deusetpatria@gmail.com

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day

Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass
on **Sunday, 6 September** at **Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry City**.
The day will begin with **Mass at 2.00pm**, celebrated by **Bishop Donal
McKeown**, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk
for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family.
For more information and booking details, please
email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

Society of St Vincent De Paul Need for SVP assistance seems
to be growing yearly. It is with the support of people like you
that we can carry on providing a 'safety net' when support
mechanisms fail.

*If you feel you could give some time to help in the efforts of
SVDP, please get in touch ON 07596 270 247
for support from SVDP call 028 90 351561*

PASTORAL COMMUNITY

HOLY FAMILY PARISH

CLERGY

Very Rev. Michael Spence PP

Rev. John O'Lavery CC

Rev. Brendan Dowd Deacon

Mass Times

HOLY FAMILY CHURCH,

14 Newington Avenue, Belfast, BT15 2HP

Sunday: Vigil (Saturday) 6pm; 10.30am

Holydays: 9.15am

Weekdays: Mon–Wed 9.15am

Novena to Our Lady of Perpetual Help: Wed at 9.15am

First Saturday Devotions: First Saturday of the month at 10am

ST THERÈSE OF LISIEUX CHURCH,

71 Somerton Road, Belfast, BT15 4DE

Sunday: 9am & 12pm

Holydays: 7pm Vigil & 10am

Weekdays: Thurs–Sat 10am

Eucharistic Adoration: Mon–Sat, 10am–4pm

ST. PATRICK'S PARISH

CLERGY

Very Rev. Francis O'Brien PP

Mass Times

ST PATRICK'S CHURCH

199 Donegall St Belfast BT1 2FL

Sunday: Vigil (Saturday) 6pm; 9am, 11am & 6pm

Holydays: Please check parish website and Facebook

Weekdays: Tues, Wed, Thurs 10am

Novena in honour of Our Lady of Perpetual Help

every Wednesday at 10am

Novena in honour of St. Anthony and Blessing with the relic of
St Anthony of Padua every Tuesday at 10am

August & September 2026 @ Lough Derg

*A pilgrimage has a vital part to play in our life of faith, for it
removes us from our daily routines, and gives us time and
space to encounter God more deeply. Pope Leo XIV*

Three Day Pilgrimages – In the tradition of prayer, fasting and
keeping Vigil -Begin on any day of the week until Thur 13th
August. - Admission €85. Discounts available for Groups,
Seniors & Students.

One Day Retreats – Guided Days of Prayer and Reflection -
places available on

August 18th, 22nd, 23rd, 29th and 31st

September 5th, 6th, 9th, 12th, 15th, 19th and 20th

Admission €50. Group discounts available. Advance Booking
Essential.

Includes Special Themed Retreats:

23rd August - St Peregrine

5th September – Pioneer Pilgrimage

6th September – St Carlos Acutis

9th & 12th September – Vocations Monstrance

19th September – Divine Mercy Pilgrimage

Heritage Day Tours – Explore one of Ireland's most enduring
and authentic spiritual destinations. Thursday 20th August.
11am & 2:30pm

As part of National Heritage Week celebrations visitors will
enjoy a guided boat trip on the lake, guided tour of Station
Island and refreshments.

Admission €15. Student & Child discounts available.

Advance Booking Essential.

Lakeshore Pilgrim Path Pilgrimage – In the footsteps of
pilgrims through the centuries

Sunday 30th August. 8km & 12km routes, fully guided.

Outdoor Mass weather permitting.

Admission €25. Advance Booking Essential.

NEW FOR 2026 SEASON –Overnight accommodation
available on Station Island the night before beginning a
Retreat or Pilgrimage. www.loughderg.org

May They Rest In Peace

Recently Deceased

Patrick Rogan, Philomena McMahon, Denis Regan,
Kieran Boylan

Months Mind

Anniversaries

Eimear McGinley nee McCann, John Carlin, Teresa Costello,
Alex McCall, Maureen McCall, Charlie McGarrity

**For the purposes of safeguarding—all children must be accompanied by
a responsible adult when using the toilet facilities in the church !**

Thank you all for all your kind and generous donations and support
for St Gerard's Parish, and thank you for all donations that have
gone through the Digital Collection Plate at the back of the church.
If you would like to donate via standing order, please contact the
Parish office for a form.
August 2nd Collections –2nd –St Gerard's Community; 9th Building
Fund ; 16th Dioc Cathedral Fund